

Borrowing James Clear's idea: Quite often problems have a well-established, rarely working, widely accepted solution and another solution which is widely negated but is often effective. From that axiom, as much enticing it is to pin success on will power, knowledge and grit, it is equally tempting to allude failure to a lack of hard work and dismiss environment. What a thousand experts, parents and teachers tell you is: you'll never win if you don't work hard. What I want to show you is: hard-work is a cog but, environment is much more effective.

Human Accounts

A few years back, I argued with my high school teachers over the importance of teaching stuff that's useful. They get back: it's never important what they teach, it only matters what skills the students learn. Years later, I got what they meant. If I had been homeschooled, my chances of surviving in the real world would be zero: yes, a big round nada. Even though what I have applied in the working world was never taught at school, '*what I am*' is because I went to school. In the closed gates of a community that was glowing with supreme talent, lax listeners and gritty workers, I found my own identity amidst an eclectic group.

An interesting exercise that Warren Buffett once lectured at UF (University of Florida): If you had to buy 25% of a person's future, what kind of a new graduate would you buy?

To be fair, when you grind it down to the real factors, you're not going to pick the person with the most IQ or the best initiatives. Your bet is probably going to be on a person who is primed to achieve as he's in a place surrounded by achievers - environment matters more than brains.



Whip out an atlas and author Jared Diamond would point to the various shapes of the continents to say that the shapes have an impact on anthropology. Your first perception might be to dismiss it as another theory by a wannabe scientist.

But dig deeper and these shapes do seem to have an important contribution to human behavior and hence to our history. To take an example, Asia and Europe are spread across the atlas while Africa and Americas are spread in